Mini’s n More — Website Administration, Business Operations & Zoho Integration Manual

14 October 2026

Cover page
  Revision history
  Table of contents
Chapter 1: Introduction and purpose
  1.1 What this website does
  1.2 What you are responsible for
  1.3 What the system handles automatically
  1.4 What requires manual action
  1.5 How the website talks to Zoho
  1.6 Who should use this manual
  1.7 When to escalate to technical support
Chapter 2: Accessing the admin panel
  2.1 URLs
  2.2 How to log in
  2.3 How to log out securely
  2.4 Password recovery
  2.5 Permissions overview
  2.6 Administrator vs customer accounts
  2.7 If the admin page does not load
  2.8 If access is denied (“Not authorised”)
  2.9 Security practices
Chapter 3: Admin dashboard overview
  3.1 Dashboard (`/admin`)
  3.2 Site settings (`/admin/settings`)
  3.3 Addresses (`/admin/addresses`)
  3.4 Package types (`/admin/package-types`)
  3.5 Contact messages (`/admin/contact-messages`)
  3.6 Banners (`/admin/banners`)
  3.7 Categories (`/admin/categories`)
  3.8 Products (`/admin/products`)
  3.9 Home sections (`/admin/home`)
  3.10 About page (`/admin/about`)
  3.11 Gift page (`/admin/gift`)
  3.12 Page visibility (`/admin/pages`)
  3.13 Coupons (`/admin/coupons`)
  3.14 Discount (`/admin/discount`)
  3.15 Blogs (`/admin/blog`)
  3.16 Policies (`/admin/policies`)
  3.17 Invoices (`/admin/invoices`)
  3.18 Orders (`/admin/orders`)
  3.19 Cancellations (`/admin/cancellations`)
  3.20 Returns & exchanges (`/admin/returns`)
  3.21 Zoho settings (`/admin/zoho`)
  3.22 Customers (`/admin/customers`)
  3.23 RBAC (`/admin/rbac`)

Chapter 4: Website configuration and feature management
4.1 Update contact details and social links
4.2 Configure shipping, GST, and COD fee
4.3 Configure return window and refund policy text
4.4 Create a category
4.5 Create or edit a product (summary)
4.6 Homepage banners
4.7 Coupons and storewide discount
4.8 Policies
4.9 Invite a staff member
4.10 Manage orders (Operations desk)
4.11 Bulk product CSV import
4.12 Blogs, gift page, home sections, page visibility
4.13 Invoices (GST presentation)
4.14 Customer account management
Chapter 5: Product, SKU, and inventory operations
5.1 Concepts
5.2 Source of truth (verified)
5.3 Worked example (fictional)
5.4 Out of stock
5.5 After orders are placed
5.6 Verifying Zoho inventory
Chapter 6: Zoho integration and daily operations
6.1 Which Zoho product is used
6.2 Business explanation
6.3 Data flow diagram
6.4 Entity reference
6.5 Admin Zoho page actions (`/admin/zoho`)
6.6 Per-product Zoho actions
6.7 Zoho webhooks (inbound from Zoho)
6.8 Scheduled jobs (background)
6.9 Record saved vs synchronized (checklist)
Chapter 7: Zoho setup, connection, and troubleshooting
7.0 Initial Zoho connection (admin steps)
7.1 Who does what
7.2 Connection symptoms
7.3 Reconciliation checklist
7.4 SKU mapping issues
Chapter 8: Complete order lifecycle
8.1 Four related status layers
8.2 Order status values
8.3 Payment status values
8.4 Tracking status (customer labels)
8.5 State transition table (order status)
8.6 Customer vs admin view
Chapter 9: Order cancellation procedure
9.1 Decision table
9.2 A. Customer requests cancellation
9.3 B. Admin initiates cancellation
9.4 C. Already shipped or delivered
9.5 D. Payment collected
9.6 E. Zoho sync failure on cancel
9.7 Shipment cancel (not order cancel)
Chapter 10: Return management
10.1 Customer submission
10.2 Admin procedure
10.3 Return case status path (verified)
Chapter 11: Exchange management
11.1 Customer submission
11.2 Approval and price difference

11.3 Fulfilment path
11.4 Scenarios
Chapter 12: Manual versus automated operations
Chapter 13: Exception handling and operational recovery
13.1 Admin cannot log in
13.2 Product not on website
13.3 Wrong price or stock
13.4 Order missing in admin
13.5 Payment vs order mismatch
13.6 Order in website but not Zoho
13.7 Return/exchange stuck
13.8 Customer no email
13.9 Escalation information checklist
Chapter 14: Daily, weekly, and monthly operations
14.1 Daily (recommended)
14.2 Weekly (recommended)
14.3 Monthly (recommended)
Chapter 15: Roles, permissions, and approvals
Chapter 16: Business rules and client decisions
Chapter 17: Glossary
Chapter 18: Final handover checklist
Appendix A — Technical escalation (for support tickets)
Appendix B — Screenshot placeholders

Cover page

Document title	Mini’s n More — Website Administration, Business Operations & Zoho Integration Manual
Version	1.0
Date	14 October 2026
Prepared for	Mini’s n More business and operations team
Prepared by	Delivery team (based on verified application code)
Primary website (UAT)	https://uat.minisnmore.com
Primary website (Production)	https://minisnmore.com

Confidentiality: This document describes operational procedures. It does not contain passwords, API keys, or OAuth secrets.

Revision history

Version	Date	Author	Summary
1.0	14 Oct 2026	Delivery team	Initial client handover manual from codebase audit

---

Table of contents

1. Introduction and purpose
2. Accessing the admin panel
3. Admin dashboard overview
4. Website configuration and feature management
5. Product, SKU, and inventory operations
6. Zoho integration and daily operations
7. Zoho setup, connection, and troubleshooting
8. Complete order lifecycle
9. Order cancellation procedure
10. Return management
11. Exchange management
12. Manual versus automated operations
13. Exception handling and operational recovery
14. Daily, weekly, and monthly operations
15. Roles, permissions, and approvals
16. Business rules and client decisions
17. Glossary
18. Final handover checklist

- Appendix A — Technical escalation (for support tickets)
- Appendix B — Screenshot placeholders

Chapter 1: Introduction and purpose

1.1 What this website does

Mini’s n More is an e-commerce website for organic baby clothing and related products. Customers can:

- Browse the shop, search, and filter by category and age.
- Create an account, manage addresses, wishlist, and cart.
- Check out with **online payment (Razorpay)** or **Cash on Delivery (COD)**.
- Track orders and, when enabled, request **cancellations**, **returns**, or **exchanges** within configured policy windows.

Your team uses the **Admin Console** and related **staff desks** to manage catalog content, pricing, orders, fulfilment, refunds, and integration with **Zoho Books** (accounting and inventory items).

1.2 What you are responsible for

As an administrator or operations user, you are typically responsible for:

Area	Examples
Merchandising	Categories, products, images, coupons, homepage content
Commerce settings	Shipping fees, GST display, return window, contact details
Orders	Review new orders, packages, shipments, COD collection
Post-order cases	Approve/reject cancellations; manage returns and exchanges
Zoho alignment	Keep OAuth connected; run controlled product/inventory sync
Customer issues	Contact messages, support escalations

1.3 What the system handles automatically

The following are **verified automated** behaviours (no button click required for each step):

- **Online payment:** Razorpay payment capture updates order payment status after successful verification.
- **Inventory reservation:** Stock is reserved when an order is placed; unreleased holds expire (online unpaid orders ~30 minutes).
- **Order sync to Zoho:** Paid orders trigger background sync to create/update Zoho Books contact, sales order, invoice, and payment (subject to connection health).
- **Tracking updates:** ExpressBees webhooks, Zoho shipment

webhooks, scheduled Zoho tracking pulls (~15 minutes), and customer order-detail refresh can update tracking.
- **Emails:** Key milestones (e.g. out-for-delivery, delivery failed, delivered) send customer emails when carrier events occur.
- **Refunds (online):** Approved cancellations and completed returns can trigger Razorpay refunds automatically.
- **Zoho webhooks:** Invoice, shipment, order status, item, and stock events from Zoho update local records when secrets and payloads are correct.

1.4 What requires manual action

Activity	Who
Approve/reject cancellation requests	Admin / Operations
Pack orders, create packages, book couriers	Operations
Mark COD collected	Admin / Operations
Approve returns/exchanges, book reverse pickup	Operations (support may approve/reject requests)
Inspect returned goods, accept/reject QC	Operations
Record COD refunds (method + reference)	Admin / Finance
Settle exchange price differences	Operations
Product merchandising and pricing	Admin
Zoho OAuth (re)connection	Admin (with Zoho org owner)
Reconciliation when sync fails	Operations + technical escalation

1.5 How the website talks to Zoho

In simple terms:

1. **Your team** changes products or fulfils orders in the **Admin Console**.
2. The **website backend** stores data in its database and calls **Zoho Books API** (India data center by default).
3. **Zoho** can also **push updates** to the website using **webhooks** (stock, shipments, invoices, etc.).

A separate **Ledgerly** integration also appears in order/cancellation/return code paths. **Client confirmation required:** whether your live environment uses Ledgerly, Zoho, or both for accounting (see `CLIENT_CONFIRMATION_AND_GAPS.md`).

1.6 Who should use this manual

Audience	Use
Admin / Super Admin	Full console: catalog, settings, Zoho, RBAC
	Orders, shipments, returns,

Operations	cancellations, invoices
Customer Support	Orders, customers, cases (limited fulfilment actions)
Sales	Product catalog view (`/sales/products`)
Finance / Zoho owner	Zoho OAuth, reconciliation, credit notes

1.7 When to escalate to technical support

Escalate when:

- Admin login works but **Zoho Test connection** fails repeatedly.
- Orders are paid on the website but **missing in Zoho** after reasonable time.
- Refunds stuck in **FAILED** with gateway errors.
- Webhooks return **401** (secret mismatch) — requires server environment update, not admin UI.
- Entire admin or storefront unavailable.
- You are asked to edit database rows, environment files, or API code.

Provide: order number, case/return number, timestamps, screenshots, and current status fields (see Appendix A).

Chapter 2: Accessing the admin panel

2.1 URLs

Environment	Storefront	Staff logi
UAT	https://uat.minisnmore.com	https://uat.minisnmore.c
Production	https://minisnmore.com	https://minisnmore.com/

After login, **Admin** users land on **Dashboard** (`/admin`). Other staff roles are redirected to their desk (Operations, Sales, or Customer Support).

2.2 How to log in

Purpose: Access authorised back-office functions.

Before starting: You must have received a **staff invitation email** and completed account activation.

Steps:

1. Open **Staff sign in** at `/admin/login`.
2. Enter your **work email** and **password** (minimum 6 characters).
3. Click **Sign in**.
4. If you have **Admin** or **Super Admin** role, you will see the full Admin sidebar. Other roles go to their assigned desk.

> **Screenshot (verified UAT):** Staff login page — hero image, “Staff sign in”, email and password fields, **Sign in** button, **Forgot password?** link, **← Back to store**.
>
> *Capture during training:* `docs/client-handover/screenshots/01-admin-login.png`

2.3 How to log out securely

1. In the Admin sidebar (desktop) or mobile nav, click **Sign out**.
2. Close the browser tab if using a shared computer.
3. Do not share your password or leave an unlocked session unattended.

2.4 Password recovery

Steps:

1. On `/admin/login`, switch to **Forgot password** (or equivalent link on the form).
2. Enter your staff email and submit.
3. Use the link in your email to set a new password (customer reset flow also exists at `/reset-password` for storefront accounts).

If you do not receive email within 15 minutes, check spam and confirm the address matches your invitation. Escalate if the account is not **Active** in RBAC.

2.5 Permissions overview

Role	Home after login	Access
Super Admin	`/admin`	Full admin + can assign any staff role
Admin	`/admin`	Full admin; can assign Sales, Operations, Customer Support
Operations	`/operations/dashboard`	Orders, returns, cancellations, invoices, customers, products, contact messages
Sales	`/sales/products`	Products only

Customer Support	`/customersupport/orders`	Orders, customers, returns, cancellations, contact messages (fulfilment actions limited)

Important: “Admin” in daily language means the **Admin Console** (`/admin`). Only **Super Admin** and **Admin** roles enter that console. Operations and Support use **separate URLs** with a similar look but narrower menus.

2.6 Administrator vs customer accounts

- **Customers** register on the storefront (`/login`) for shopping.
- **Staff** use the same authentication system but hold **ROLE_*** authorities** assigned in **RBAC** (`/admin/rbac`).
- A staff email should not be used as a personal shopping account without clarity on roles.

2.7 If the admin page does not load

1. Check internet connection and try the storefront homepage.
2. Confirm the correct hostname (UAT vs production).
3. Try another browser or clear cache.
4. If the whole site is down, escalate to technical support.

2.8 If access is denied (“Not authorised”)

1. Confirm you signed in with the intended email.
2. Ask a Super Admin to verify your role under **RBAC**.
3. If you are Operations but opened `/admin`, you will be redirected — use `/operations/dashboard` instead.

2.9 Security practices

- Use strong unique passwords.
- Do not share invitation links.
- Do not paste API secrets into **Policies**, **Blogs**, or product descriptions.
- Report suspected compromise immediately.

Chapter 3: Admin dashboard overview

The left navigation is defined in the application (`Admin` sidebar). Use **Search pages...** to filter menu items quickly.

> **Screenshot placeholder:** Full Admin sidebar with Dashboard selected — label each nav item 1–n during live training.

3.1 Dashboard (`/admin`)

Used for	High-level counts: categories, products, SKUs, coupons, blogs, pages, banners, policies; returns summary when post-order UI enabled
Who	Admin
Actions	Quick links to common areas
After save	Read-only overview

3.2 Site settings (`/admin/settings`)

Used for	Brand, contact, social links, footer, **GST**, **shipping**, **COD fee**, **return window**, refund policy days, e-catalogue PDF
Who	Admin
Verify before save	Phone/email accuracy; GST and shipping amounts; return window days
Impact	Storefront checkout totals, policy text, customer eligibility for returns

3.3 Addresses (`/admin/addresses`)

Warehouse, dispatch, invoice, and registered office addresses used on documents and fulfilment.

3.4 Package types (`/admin/package-types`)

Box types and dimensions for packing and courier booking.

3.5 Contact messages (`/admin/contact-messages`)

Customer **Contact Us** submissions — read and follow up by email/phone outside the system if needed.

3.6 Banners (`/admin/banners`)

Homepage **hero carousel** slides (images, links, ordering).

3.7 Categories (`/admin/categories`)

Catalog navigation folders; products must reference a category.

3.8 Products (`/admin/products`)

Master catalog: SKUs, variants, prices, stock, images, Zoho push/pull per product.

3.9 Home sections (`/admin/home`)

Merchandising: shop-by-age, reviews, featured products, watch & shop reels.

3.10 About page (`/admin/about`)

Founders/story content for `/about`.

3.11 Gift page (`/admin/gift`)

Gifting landing content.

3.12 Page visibility (`/admin/pages`)

Show or hide storefront routes from navigation.

3.13 Coupons (`/admin/coupons`)

Promotional codes (including BOGO-style offers where configured).

3.14 Discount (`/admin/discount`)

Storewide percentage off MRP (interacts with product `compare_at_price`).

3.15 Blogs (`/admin/blog`)

Blog posts for `/blog`.

3.16 Policies (`/admin/policies`)

Legal and policy pages: terms, privacy, return, shipping.

3.17 Invoices (`/admin/invoices`)

GST invoice copy settings and related billing presentation.

3.18 Orders (`/admin/orders`)

Order list, detail, packages, shipments, COD, Zoho sync indicators, admin cancel when allowed.

3.19 Cancellations (`/admin/cancellations`)

Customer cancellation **requests** — approve, reject, record COD refund, retry failed refunds.

Hidden if `VITE_SHOW_M2_POST_ORDER_UI` is false at build time.

3.20 Returns & exchanges (`/admin/returns`)

Return and exchange cases — approve, pickup, inspect, refund, replacement shipment, exchange settlement.

3.21 Zoho settings (`/admin/zoho`)

OAuth connection, credentials, test connection, bulk pull/push products and inventory, order retry tools.

3.22 Customers (`/admin/customers`)

Registered buyers — search, view join date; link to RBAC for staff.

3.23 RBAC (`/admin/rbac`)

Invite staff, assign roles, resend invites, deactivate users.

Chapter 4: Website configuration and feature management

This chapter uses a standard procedure template for major tasks.

4.1 Update contact details and social links

Purpose: Keep footer, contact page, and WhatsApp links correct.

Before starting: Admin role; approved marketing copy.

Steps:

1. Open **Site settings** (`/admin/settings`).
2. Expand **Contact** (or use section toggles).
3. Update **Contact email**, **Contact phone**, **WhatsApp number**, and social URLs.

4. Click **Save**.
5. Open the storefront footer and **Contact Us** to verify.

Expected result: New details visible on the live site within minutes.

Impact: Customers and courier SMS/email may use these values.

Common mistakes: Wrong country code on phone; http vs https on social URLs.

4.2 Configure shipping, GST, and COD fee

Purpose: Control checkout totals.

Steps:

1. **Site settings → Pricing** section.
2. Set **GST rate**, whether prices include GST, **standard/express shipping** amounts, **free shipping minimum**, and **COD handling fee**.
3. Save and place a **test cart** (on UAT) to verify totals.

Impact: Every new checkout; does not change already-placed orders.

4.3 Configure return window and refund policy text

Purpose: Control how many days after delivery customers may request returns/exchanges.

Steps:

1. **Site settings → Returns** section.
2. Set **Return window (days)** (default **3**, max **90**).
3. Set **Refund min/max business days** for customer-facing policy copy.
4. Save.

Impact: Eligibility API and account returns page use these values.

Client confirmation required: Align with legal return policy in **Policies** editor.

4.4 Create a category

Purpose: Organise products in the shop menu.

Steps:

1. Open **Categories** (`/admin/categories`).
2. Click add/new (or edit existing).
3. Enter **name**, **slug** (URL segment), optional image and description.
4. Set **active** and sort order if shown.
5. Save and confirm category appears on `/shop`.

Impact: Products require a valid category.

4.5 Create or edit a product (summary)

See **Chapter 5** for full SKU/inventory detail.

Required fields (marked * in UI): Name, Category, SKU, Fabric type, Selling price, Stock, Age range.

Steps:

1. **Products → New product** or select existing.
2. Complete required fields; upload images.
3. For **variant** products, use the variant matrix (prints × sizes); parent price/stock become read-only sums.
4. Save.
5. Optional: **Push to Zoho** from product actions when SKU is set.

Impact: Storefront visibility controlled by **active** flag; stock affects sellability.

4.6 Homepage banners

Purpose: Promote campaigns on the hero carousel.

Steps:

1. **Banners** (`/admin/banners`).
2. Add slide image, headline, link target, sort order.
3. Save and review homepage carousel.

4.7 Coupons and storewide discount

Tool	Path	Effect
Coupons	`/admin/coupons`	Code customer enters at checkout
Discount	`/admin/discount`	Percent off MRP across catalog

Verify interaction: selling price may be derived from MRP minus storewide discount when `compare_at_price` is set.

4.8 Policies

Purpose: Legal and customer-facing policy pages.

Steps:

1. **Policies** (`/admin/policies`).
2. Edit **Terms**, **Privacy**, **Return**, **Shipping** content.
3. Save and open public URLs (`/terms`, `/privacy`, etc.).

Warning: Do not paste secrets or internal URLs with tokens.

4.9 Invite a staff member

Purpose: Grant controlled back-office access.

Before starting: Super Admin or Admin role.

Steps:

1. Open **RBAC** (`/admin/rbac`).
2. Enter first name, last name, email, **role**.
3. Click **Send invitation**.
4. Ask the user to complete the invite link and set password.
5. Confirm **Active** status in the staff table.

Impact: Role determines which desk and actions they see.

Common mistakes: Assigning Admin when Operations was intended (over-broad access).

4.10 Manage orders (Operations desk)

Purpose: Fulfil customer orders from payment through delivery.

Before starting: Operations or Admin role; understand difference between **cancel shipment** and **cancel order** (Chapter 9).

Steps:

1. Open **Orders** (`/admin/orders` or `/operations/orders`).
2. Use filters: payment status, order status, tracking status (including **ExpressBees cancelled** when courier voids AWB).
3. Open an order row to expand detail.
4. Verify **payment**: for COD with `PENDING` payment, collect cash/UPI on delivery then use **Mark COD collected**.
5. Create **package** when items are packed (**Create package** dialog) — contributes to **hand-wrapped** state when Zoho package exists.
6. **Book shipment** — ExpressBees (API) or manual carrier; enter AWB when manual.
7. Monitor tracking until **delivered**; handle **carrier_cancelled** by rebooking or cancelling order.
8. If **pending cancellation** banner appears, resolve on **Cancellations** before booking new shipment (unless audited override by technical process).

Expected result: Customer sees tracking progress on account; order reaches **FULFILLED** on delivery.

Impact: Zoho shipment webhooks update tracking; inventory already reserved at order time.

Common mistakes: Booking AWB before inventory confirmed; cancelling shipment thinking it refunds customer.

4.11 Bulk product CSV import

Purpose: Load many products at once.

Before starting: Categories must exist; backup current catalog before large imports on production.

Steps:

1. **Products** → import / CSV template (download template from UI if offered).
2. Required columns include: `slug`, `name`, `sku`, `category_slug`, `price`, `age_range`, `fabric_type`, `stock`, `active`.
3. Upload file and review validation errors.
4. Fix rows and re-import failed lines only.
5. Spot-check 3 SKUs on storefront and Zoho.

Impact: Incorrect SKUs break Zoho stock webhooks.

4.12 Blogs, gift page, home sections, page visibility

Page	Path	Operational note
Blogs	`/admin/blog`	Publish date and slug affect `/blog/{slug}`
Gift page	`/admin/gift`	Marketing content only
Home sections	`/admin/home`	Controls curated homepage modules
Page visibility	`/admin/pages`	Hiding a page removes nav links — does not delete routes

---

4.13 Invoices (GST presentation)

Purpose: Company legal name, CIN, registered address on downloadable invoices.

Steps: `/admin/invoices` → update copy → download sample invoice from an order (`/admin/orders/{orderNumber}/invoice`).

4.14 Customer account management

Purpose: View registered customers (not staff).

Steps: `/admin/customers` → search email → view profile timeline. For staff accounts use **RBAC**, not Customers.

Chapter 5: Product, SKU, and inventory operations

5.1 Concepts

Term	Meaning
Product	What customers see on the shop (one page per style)
SKU	Unique stock-keeping code (parent SKU for simple products; variant SKUs for each size/colour combo)
Variant	Size and colour combination with its own SKU, price, and stock
Stock	Quantity available to sell on the **website database**
Active	If off, product hidden from shop but history preserved

5.2 Source of truth (verified)

Data	Primary on website	Synced to Zoho
Merchandising (name, description, images)	Admin catalog	Push/pull
Selling price / MRP	Admin (variant matrix)	Push/pull
Stock on hand	Admin + order reservations	Pull inventory, stock webhook, push on change
Orders	Website	Zoho sales order / invoice

Client confirmation required when Ledgerly is enabled in your deployment (may override pull direction).

5.3 Worked example (fictional)

Product: “Blush Petal Bodysuit”
Parent SKU: `MNM-BPB-001`
Variant: Size `6-12M`, Print `Rose` → SKU `MNM-BPB-001-6M-ROSE`, stock `25`, price `₹899`

Steps to launch:

1. Create category `bodysuits`.
2. Create product with required fields, set structure to **variants**, add size/colour rows.
3. Upload images; set **active** on.
4. **Push to Zoho** (or pull from Zoho if item already exists there).
5. Verify on `/shop` and in Zoho Books **Items**.

5.4 Out of stock

- Set variant or simple product stock to **0** — checkout should block

or show unavailable.
- Prefer **active off** to delist discontinued styles instead of deleting SKUs with order history.

5.5 After orders are placed

- Changing price does not alter past orders (lines are snapshotted).
- Stock was reserved at order time; cancellations and returns restore stock per workflow rules.

5.6 Verifying Zoho inventory

1. Open product in **Admin → Products** — note SKU and stock.
2. In Zoho Books, open the matching **Item** by SKU.
3. After **Pull inventory** on `/admin/zoho`, website stock should match Zoho `stock_on_hand` for that SKU.
4. If mismatch persists, check recent orders (reserved stock) and webhook health (Chapter 7).

Chapter 6: Zoho integration and daily operations

6.1 Which Zoho product is used

The application integrates with **Zoho Books API v3** (India host: `zohoapis.in`). It does **not** call Zoho CRM or a separate Zoho Inventory API as the primary integration path. Inventory-related features are modelled through **Books items** and webhooks.

6.2 Business explanation

Zoho Books holds your **items (SKUs)**, **customer contacts**, **sales orders**, **invoices**, **payments**, and **credit notes**. The website:

- **Pushes** catalog changes you make in Admin.
- **Pulls** catalog and stock when you request it.
- **Creates** sales documents when customers pay.
- **Receives webhooks** when your team updates fulfilment or stock in Zoho.

6.3 Data flow diagram

```
flowchart LR
  subgraph Customer
    A[Storefront / Checkout]
  end
  subgraph Website
    B[Admin Console]
    C[Backend database]
```

```
end
subgraph Zoho
  D[Zoho Books API]
  E[Zoho Webhooks]
end
A --> C
B --> C
C -->|OAuth API calls| D
E -->|HTTPS POST| C
D -->|Responses| C
```

Legend:

- **Saved on website** = row exists in database.
- **Sent to Zoho** = API call returned success (check sync fields on order/product).
- **Confirmed in Zoho** = you can open the record in Zoho Books UI.
- **Synchronized** = website and Zoho agree on IDs/status (may still need webhook for shipment).

6.4 Entity reference

Entity	Created by	Sync mechanism	Admin verification
Items / SKUs	Admin or Zoho	Push product, pull products, item webhook	Product row Zoho id; Books → Items
Stock	Both	Stock webhook, pull inventory, order reservation	Compare SKU stock
Customer contact	Website on order	Order sync	Zoho contact linked to order
Sales order	Website	Order sync + webhooks	Order detail Zoho fields
Invoice / payment	Website / Zoho	Order sync, invoice webhook	Invoice admin + Zoho
Credit note	Website on return	Return refund action	Zoho credit note id on case
Shipment / delivery	Zoho / ExpressBees	Shipment webhook, carrier	Tracking on order

6.5 Admin Zoho page actions (`/admin/zoho`)

Action	When to use
Save credentials / Connect	Initial setup or token expiry
Test connection	Daily health check
Sync all products to Zoho	New catalog on website — off-peak only
Pull products from Zoho	Zoho edited items — default incremental
Pull inventory	Refresh all stock from Zoho

Retry failed orders	Orders with sync errors
Pull order tracking	Manual refresh when webhooks delayed

Warning: Long jobs may take **several minutes**. Do not refresh until the UI reports completion or failure.

6.6 Per-product Zoho actions

On **Products**, for each row:

- **Push** — requires SKU; sends item to Books.
- **Pull** — requires Zoho item id or SKU.

Variant products: pull/push at variant level where applicable.

6.7 Zoho webhooks (inbound from Zoho)

Zoho sends HTTPS POST requests to the website when events occur. Operations staff do not configure these in admin UI — the Zoho org administrator and technical team maintain them. You should know what they **do**:

Webhook type	Business effect when working
Invoice	Updates local invoice/payment/void state when invoice paid or voided in Zoho
Shipment	Updates tracking; **delivered** from shipment fulfilled — not from invoice alone
Sales order status	Accounting states (invoiced, void, cancelled); **fulfilled** on sales order alone does **not** mark customer delivered
Item	Refreshes one product when item edited in Zoho
Stock	Sets website stock for SKU to Zoho `stock_on_hand`

Operational rule: Trust **shipment fulfilled** for delivery to customer, not sales-order fulfilled from invoicing.

Production webhook URL paths (for Zoho admin reference only):

- Invoice: `https://minisnmore.com/api/v1/zoho/invoice-webhook`
- Stock: `https://minisnmore.com/api/v1/zoho/stock-webhook`
- Shipment / order status / item: under `/internal/v1/zoho/...` (gateway)

UAT hosts need matching URLs in Zoho if testing webhooks on UAT.

6.8 Scheduled jobs (background)

Job	Typical frequency	Effect
Zoho order sync retry	On failure /	Pushes stuck orders

	schedule	
Zoho tracking pull	~15 minutes	Updates shipment state
Unpaid order release	~30 min hold	Cancels unpaid online orders

Disabling `ZOHO_AUTO_SYNC_ENABLED` or `ZOHO_ORDER_TRACKING_ENABLED` in server config stops schedulers — **webhooks still work**. This is technical configuration, not an admin toggle.

6.9 Record saved vs synchronized (checklist)

When training staff, use this checklist on one test order:

1. ☐ Order visible in **Orders** with correct lines and total.
2. ☐ `payment_status` = PAID (or PENDING for COD).
3. ☐ Zoho Books shows **sales order** with same reference/SKU lines.
4. ☐ Invoice exists and matches amount (may lag seconds/minutes).
5. ☐ After shipment in Zoho, website tracking shows **On the way** / **Delivered**.

If step 3 fails but step 1 succeeds, the website record exists but is **not synchronized** — use retry tools (Chapter 7).

Chapter 7: Zoho setup, connection, and troubleshooting

7.0 Initial Zoho connection (admin steps)

Purpose: Allow the website to read and write Zoho Books on your organisation's behalf.

Before starting: Zoho Books organisation ID; API client created in Zoho API console; redirect URL whitelisted (`https://minisnmore.com/admin/zoho` for production).

Steps:

1. Open **Zoho settings** (`/admin/zoho`).
2. Enter **Org ID** (6–15 digits), **Client ID**, **Client secret** (first time only), **Data center** (India = `in`).
3. Click **Save**.
4. Click **Connect to Zoho Books** — sign in as Zoho org admin and approve access.
5. On return, page should show connected state.
6. Click **Test connection** — toast should show organisation name.
7. Do **not** run full catalog pull until agreed (Chapter 6).

Expected result: `connected: true` and test succeeds.

Never paste client secret or refresh token into email or this manual.

7.1 Who does what

Task	Business admin	Zoho org admin	Technical support
Connect OAuth on `/admin/zoho`	✓	Assists with API console	
Create Zoho API client + redirect URL		✓	✓
Set webhook secrets in server			✓
Retry order sync in admin	✓		
Fix nginx/gateway routing			✓

7.2 Connection symptoms

Symptom	Likely cause	Safe admin action
Test connection fails	Expired token, wrong org id	Re-connect OAuth
401 on webhooks	Secret mismatch	Escalate — do not change prod env yourself
Product pull stops mid-way	Zoho rate limit (429)	Wait 15–60 min; retry smaller scope
Order not in Zoho	Sync failed at checkout	Use order retry tools; note error message

7.3 Reconciliation checklist

1. Find website order number.
2. Note `zoho_sync_status` / error on order detail (admin).
3. Search Zoho Books for sales order by reference or customer.
4. If duplicate exists, **stop** and escalate — do not create manual duplicate orders.
5. Document event ids from webhook tables (technical team) if repeats occur.

7.4 SKU mapping issues

- SKU on website must match Zoho item SKU for stock webhooks.
- Variant products need SKU on each variant row.

Chapter 8: Complete order lifecycle

8.1 Four related status layers

1. **Order status** (`status`) — fulfilment milestone on the order.
2. **Payment status** (`payment_status`) — money collected or refunded.
3. **Tracking status** — customer-facing delivery progress (computed).
4. **Return / cancellation case status** — separate records.

8.2 Order status values

Status	Meaning
`PENDING`	Placed; awaiting online payment
`CONFIRMED`	Accepted for fulfilment
`HAND_WRAPPED`	Package exists (Zoho package / hand-wrap signal)
`FULFILLED`	Delivered / complete
`CANCELLED`	Order cancelled

8.3 Payment status values

Status	Meaning
`PENDING`	Not paid (or COD not collected)
`PAID`	Payment received
`FAILED`	Online payment failed
`REFUNDED`	Refund completed

8.4 Tracking status (customer labels)

Internal	Customer sees
`pending`	Awaiting payment
`confirmed`	Order confirmed
`hand_wrapped`	Hand-wrapped
`awaiting_pickup`	Waiting for pickup
`shipped`	On the way
`out_for_delivery`	Out for delivery
`delivery_failed`	Delivery attempt unsuccessful
`delivered`	Delivered
`cancelled`	Cancelled

8.5 State transition table (order status)

From	To	Trigger	Auto / manual
—	PENDING	Online checkout placed	Auto
—	CONFIRMED	COD placed or payment	Auto

		verified	
CONFIRMED	HAND_WRAPPED	Package created	Manual ops / Zoho package webhook
HAND_WRAPPED	FULFILLED	Delivered signal	Webhook / carrier
*	CANCELLED	Approved cancellation or admin cancel	Manual approve / admin
PENDING	CANCELLED	Payment timeout / release	Auto

Prohibited: Cancelling after AWB booked (must use returns). Do not set delivered from invoice-paid alone — shipment proof required.

8.6 Customer vs admin view

- Customers see tracking + payment summary on **Account → Orders** and **Track order**.
- Admins see sync fields, package tools, and action buttons on **Orders**.

Chapter 9: Order cancellation procedure

9.1 Decision table

Order state	Payment	Customer action	Admin action
Confirmed, no AWB	Paid online	Request cancel	Approve → auto Razorpay refund + cancel
Confirmed, no AWB	COD not collected	Request cancel	Approve → cancel (no refund)
Confirmed, no AWB	COD collected	Request cancel	Approve → cancel + **record COD refund**
AWB booked or later	Any	Request blocked	Direct to returns if delivered
Any eligible	Paid	—	**Cancel order** on Orders if flags allow

9.2 A. Customer requests cancellation

1. Customer submits request from account (creates **REQUESTED** case).
2. Open **Cancellations** (`/admin/cancellations` or Operations desk).
3. Search by order number or date.
4. Verify payment and tracking (no AWB yet).
5. **Approve** — system cancels order, restores stock, syncs Zoho/Ledgerly, refunds Razorpay if paid online.
6. **Reject** — enter reason (min 5 characters); customer notified; fulfilment continues.
7. For COD with cash already collected, use **Record COD refund** after approval.

9.3 B. Admin initiates cancellation

On **Orders**, use **Cancel order** when `can_admin_cancel` is true. Provide reason (min 5 characters). If ExpressBees AWB is live, you may need to void shipment as part of the flow.

9.4 C. Already shipped or delivered

Cancellation is **not** supported. Use **Returns & exchanges** (Chapter 10–11) if within return window.

9.5 D. Payment collected

- **Online:** Refund tied to approval; retry available if FAILED.
- **COD:** Manual record of refund method and reference.

9.6 E. Zoho sync failure on cancel

1. Confirm order shows **CANCELLED** locally.
2. Check Zoho sales order status.
3. Use retry tools or escalate with order number — do not duplicate orders in Zoho manually without guidance.

9.7 Shipment cancel (not order cancel)

Cancel shipment voids courier booking only. Order stays open for rebook or separate cancellation workflow.

Chapter 10: Return management

10.1 Customer submission

1. Customer opens eligible delivered order in account.
2. Selects items/quantities and reason.
3. Case created as **REQUESTED**.

10.2 Admin procedure

1. Open **Returns & exchanges** (`/admin/returns`).
2. Filter **Returns**; locate case.
3. Review photos/notes if provided.
4. **Approve** or **Reject** (reason to customer).
5. Book **reverse pickup** (ExpressBees or manual/self-ship).
6. Monitor pickup milestones → **RECEIVED** at warehouse.
7. **Inspect** → **Accept** or reject QC (partial quantities supported).
8. **Refund** — triggers Razorpay for online; COD refund recording for cash orders.
9. Confirm case **REFUNDED** and order `payment_status` updated.
10. Verify **credit note** in Zoho/Ledgerly via technical checklist.

10.3 Return case status path (verified)

`REQUESTED` → `APPROVED` → `PICKUP_SCHEDULED` → `PICKED_UP` → `RECEIVED` → `INSPECTED` → `ACCEPTED` → `REFUNDED`

Branches: `REJECTED`, `PICKUP_FAILED`, `FAILED` (refund retry), `CANCELLED` (customer withdraws while REQUESTED).

Chapter 11: Exchange management

11.1 Customer submission

Select order line, replacement size/colour, reason. System validates variant availability and no duplicate open case.

11.2 Approval and price difference

On **Approve**, replacement stock is **reserved**. Settlement:

Difference	Action
Replacement more expensive	Collect difference before outbound
Cheaper	Refund difference (Razorpay or manual)
Same	No settlement
Waived	Manager override (confirm policy)

Outbound booking blocked while settlement **PENDING**.

11.3 Fulfilment path

`ACCEPTED` → `ITEM_ALLOCATED` → `REPACKING` → `READY_TO_SHIP` → `SHIPPED` → `DELIVERED` → `COMPLETED`

11.4 Scenarios

Scenario	Handling
Replacement OOS	Convert exchange to refund
Pickup failed	Reschedule or close case
Inspection fail	Reject or partial accept per policy
Replacement shipment	Book outbound AWB; customer sees outbound tracking link

Original order remains **delivered** in tracking — show exchange case status separately to customers.

Chapter 12: Manual versus automated operations

Activity	Trigger	Automatic action	Admin action	Z ac
Place order	Customer checkout	Reserve stock, create order	—	Syn que on pay
Online payment	Razorpay	Mark PAID, CONFIRMED	—	Sal ord pip
COD order	Customer	CONFIRMED, payment PENDING	Collect cash on delivery	Syn rul
Package / hand-wrap	Ops / Zoho	Status HAND_WRAPPED	Create package in admin	Pac wel
Book ExpressBees	Ops	AWB, awaiting_pickup	Book in UI	—
Shipped / delivered	Carrier/Zoho	Tracking emails, FULFILLED	—	Shi wel
Cancel request	Customer	Holds shipment booking	Approve/reject	Can syn
Return refund	Ops accept	Razorpay refund, stock restore	Inspect, refund click	Cre not
Exchange ship	Ops	Notifications	Book outbound	Sto pus run
Product push	Admin	API to Books	Click push	Iten upd
Pull inventory	Admin schedule	Overwrite local stock	Run pull	Rea iten
Stock webhook	Zoho	Update SKU qty	—	Wel POS

Classifications: **AUTOMATED**, **MANUAL**, **PARTIALLY AUTOMATED** as indicated in columns.

Chapter 13: Exception handling and operational recovery

13.1 Admin cannot log in

Step	Action
1	Verify email/password; use forgot password
2	Check RBAC — account **Active**?
3	Confirm correct site (UAT vs prod)
Escalate	If activated but still fails

13.2 Product not on website

Check **active** flag, category, stock > 0, page visibility, cache (hard refresh).

13.3 Wrong price or stock

Edit product or variant; run controlled Zoho pull; check storewide discount.

13.4 Order missing in admin

Search by order number; check filters; verify environment.

13.5 Payment vs order mismatch

Compare `payment_status` and Razorpay dashboard; use sync-payment tools (technical) if provided on order.

13.6 Order in website but not Zoho

Retry sync from Zoho page or order detail; capture error text; escalate.

13.7 Return/exchange stuck

Identify case status; check settlement pending, pickup failed, or refund FAILED; use retry actions in UI.

13.8 Customer no email

Check spam; verify contact email on order; escalate if mail service down.

13.9 Escalation information checklist

- ☐ Order number / return number / cancellation request id
- ☐ Timestamp (IST)
- ☐ Current `status`, `payment_status`, tracking
- ☐ Zoho sales order / invoice id if known
- ☐ Screenshot of admin error toast
- ☐ Steps already attempted

Do not send: passwords, full card numbers, webhook secrets.

Chapter 14: Daily, weekly, and monthly operations

14.1 Daily (recommended)

- ☐ New orders — confirm payment and address
- ☐ **REQUESTED** cancellations and returns
- ☐ Orders awaiting shipment booking
- ☐ ExpressBees / carrier exceptions (`delivery_failed`, `carrier_cancelled`)
- ☐ Zoho **Test connection** if prior failures
- ☐ Contact messages inbox

14.2 Weekly (recommended)

- ☐ Sample reconciliation: 5 orders website ↔ Zoho
- ☐ Inventory spot-check high-velocity SKUs
- ☐ Review refund FAILED cases
- ☐ Review inactive products still receiving traffic

14.3 Monthly (recommended)

- ☐ RBAC audit — remove leavers
- ☐ Review return window vs policy text
- ☐ Review coupon usage and expired codes
- ☐ Confirm OAuth still valid (no surprise expiry)

These checklists are operational controls — not all have automated reminders in the app today.

Chapter 15: Roles, permissions, and approvals

Role	Catalog	Orders fulfil	Cancel approve	Return refund	Zoho bulk
Super Admin	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Admin	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Operations	View/edit products	✓	✓	✓	Limited
Customer Support	—	View; limited ship	Approve/reject*	Limited*	—
Sales	Products	—	—	—	—

*Support desk: fulfilment flags off for some actions (`canFulfill` false) — booking shipments may require Operations.

Proposed control (client approval): Manager sign-off for WAIVED exchange differences and high-value refunds.

Chapter 16: Business rules and client decisions

See dedicated register: **`CLIENT_CONFIRMATION_AND_GAPS.md`**.

Summary of highest priority decisions:

1. Return window days vs marketing copy
2. Ledgerly vs Zoho ownership for orders and stock
3. COD refund authority
4. Cancellation after hand-wrap
5. Escalation contacts and SLAs

Chapter 17: Glossary

Term	Plain English
Admin panel	Password-protected back-office (Admin Console at `/admin`)
SKU	Unique product code used for inventory and Zoho items
Inventory / stock	How many units you can sell
Order status	Internal fulfilment stage (confirmed, shipped, etc.)
Payment gateway	Razorpay — processes online card/UPI payments
Refund	Money returned to customer
Return	Customer sends product back for refund
Exchange	Customer swaps for another variant/product

API	Machine interface between website and Zoho (you use buttons, not APIs)
Webhook	Zoho automatically notifying the website when something changes
Synchronization	Making website and Zoho agree on data
OAuth	Secure Zoho login used once to grant ongoing access
Invoice	Tax/billing document
Credit note	Accounting document for refunds/returns
Reconciliation	Checking two systems match
Background job	Server task that runs on a schedule (e.g. tracking pull)
AWB	Courier tracking number

Chapter 18: Final handover checklist

#	Item	Evidence	Done
1	Admin access verified for each role	Login test	☐
2	Password reset demonstrated		☐
3	Product create/edit on UAT	Product visible on shop	☐
4	Variant product demonstrated		☐
5	Order lifecycle walkthrough		☐
6	Cancellation approve/reject		☐
7	Return or exchange end-to-end		☐
8	Zoho connection + one sync		☐
9	Manual responsibilities assigned	RACI sheet	☐
10	`CLIENT_CONFIRMATION_AND_GAPS.md` reviewed	Signatures	☐
11	Troubleshooting chapter reviewed		☐
12	Client acceptance sign-off	Section 6 of gaps doc	☐

Client representative: _____ **Date:** _____

Delivery representative: _____ **Date:** _____

Appendix A — Technical escalation (for support tickets)

Include:

- Environment URL
- Order / case numbers
- User role attempting action

- Exact button clicked and error message
- Whether Zoho Books shows a matching sales order

Technical staff may check webhook event tables and server logs — not required for daily admins.

Appendix B — Screenshot placeholders

Capture during authenticated training (no real customer PII):

ID	Screen	Path
S1	Staff login	`/admin/login`
S2	Admin dashboard	`/admin`
S3	Products editor	`/admin/products`
S4	Site settings	`/admin/settings`
S5	Orders list	`/admin/orders`
S6	Order detail — package/shipment	`/admin/orders`
S7	Cancellations desk	`/admin/cancellations`
S8	Returns desk	`/admin/returns`
S9	Zoho settings	`/admin/zoho`
S10	RBAC	`/admin/rbac`
S11	Storefront home	`/`
S12	Customer order tracking	`/account/orders`

Store under `docs/client-handover/screenshots/` with descriptive filenames.

End of manual.